SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

9 October 2024 · Shift 2

74 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 16 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 11 questions

Q.1

How much sugar at ₹68/kg should be added to 20 kg of tea worth ₹440/kg so that the mixture be worth ₹130/kg?

(A) 110 kg
(B) 100 kg
(C) 80 kg
(D) 120 kg

Q.2

A shopkeeper buys two varieties of sugar at ₹120 and ₹80 per kg, respectively, and mixes them in the ratio 2 : 3. He then sets the marked price of each kg of the blended sugar at 50% above the cost he incurred per kg of the same, and then sold it after offering a 25% discount on the marked price. At what price (in ₹) did the shopkeeper sell each kg of the blended sugar?

(A) 144
(B) 114
(C) 108
(D) 120

Q.3

What sum (in ₹) will earn a simple interest of ₹240 in 3 years at 16% per year rate of interest?

(A) 250
(B) 750
(C) 1000
(D) 500

Q.6

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3000 as a sum borrowed at 9% per year rate of interest for 2 years.

(A) 540
(B) 580
(C) 500
(D) 480

Q.7

The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 69 kg and 37 kg is:

(A) 49.2
(B) 51.2
(C) 52.2
(D) 50.2

Q.8

Find the selling price of an article (in ₹) if the cost price is ₹4,500 and gain is 5%.

(A) 5,527
(B) 4,657
(C) 5,175
(D) 4,725

Q.9

Akash, Ajay, Sonia, Anju and Rohit are in a group. The average marks scored by their group is 27. Akash left the group and now the average of the remaining students is 24. How many marks did Akash score?

(A) 39
(B) 35
(C) 32
(D) 15

Q.13

The average age of a family consisting of parents and a child five years ago was 27 years. Three years ago, the average age of parents was 41. The child was born _____ years ago.

(A) 2
(B) 16
(C) 4
(D) 8

Q.15

Find the simple interest on ₹36,000 at an annual rate of 22% over an 8 month period.

(A) ₹5,275
(B) ₹5,290
(C) ₹5,280
(D) ₹5,270

Q.19

The average weight of a family of 8 members is 56 kg. The grandfather and the grandmother came to visit the family. Now, the average weight of 10 members of the family is 64 kg. Find the average weight (in kg) of the grandparents.

(A) 96
(B) 90
(C) 92
(D) 94

Q.20

Two numbers are in the ratio 3 : 7. Their L.C.M. is 126. Find the sum of the numbers.

(A) 64
(B) 69
(C) 60
(D) 90

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, 'RISK' is coded as '2369' and 'CRAP' is coded as '1876'. What is the code for 'R' in the given code language?

(A) 9
(B) 6
(C) 7
(D) 8

Q.2

KQNT is related to QWTZ in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, IOLR is related to OURX. To which of the following is DJGM related, following the same logic?

(A) JPSM
(B) JPMS
(C) PJMS
(D) PJSM

Q.4

Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). G is sitting second to the right of B. Only two people are sitting between E and C when counted from the left of E. G is an immediate neighbour of E. A is sitting second to the left of C. D is not an immediate neighbour of B. What is the position of F with respect to G?

(A) Third to the left
(B) Second to the right
(C) Third to the right
(D) Fourth to the left

Q.5

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 60 + 9 ÷ 63 – 72 × 12 = ?

(A) –504
(B) –503
(C) –501
(D) –502

Q.6

Two statements are given followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All strawberries are fruits. II. Some berries are strawberries. Conclusions: I. All berries are fruits. II. Some fruits are strawberries. III. No berry is a fruit.

(A) Both conclusions II and III follow.
(B) Only conclusion II follows.
(C) Only conclusion III follows.
(D) Either conclusion I or III follows.

Q.8

EO 19 is related to AK 13 in a certain way. In the same way, UD 17 is related to QZ 11. To which of the following is VH 23 related, following the same logic?

(A) RC 17
(B) RD 18
(C) RD 17
(D) QC 17

Q.9

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 8796, 4392, 1092, 176, ?, –4.4

(A) 38
(B) 16
(C) 22
(D) 11.6

Q.10

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (6, 17, 41) (3, 20, 32)

(A) (12, 15, 53)
(B) (23, 4, 96)
(C) (7, 16, 14)
(D) (9, 6, 40)

Q.11

What should come in place of question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? ZWT, WUQ, TSN, QQK, ?

(A) NOQ
(B) MOH
(C) NOH
(D) MOG

Q.12

This question has two statements followed by two conclusions numbered I and II. You have to take the given statements to be true even if they seem to be at variance from commonly known facts. You have to decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the given statements. Statements: No motor is a yak. Some yaks are wipes. Conclusions: (I) No wipe is a yak. (II) Some wipes are yaks.

(A) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(B) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(C) Only conclusion (II) follows
(D) Only conclusion (I) follows

Q.14

Seven people P, Q, R, S, T, U and V are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). U is sitting second to the right of S. Q is sitting third to the left of U. R is sitting fifth to the right of P. T is sitting third to the left of V. What is the position of S with respect to V?

(A) Third to the right
(B) To the immediate right
(C) To the immediate left
(D) Second to the left

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'FOAM' is coded as '9618' and 'MUST' is coded as '4536'. What is the code for 'M' in that language?

(A) 4
(B) 6
(C) 5
(D) 3

Q.17

Which of the following interchanges of signs would make the given equation correct? 8 – 42 + 104 ÷ 13 × 4 = 18

(A) ÷ and –
(B) + and ×
(C) – and ×
(D) – and +

Q.18

425 is related to 85 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 265 is related to 53. To which of the following is 655 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 132
(B) 130
(C) 136
(D) 131

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'PINK' is coded as 15 and 'PAINT' is coded as 24. How will 'WILDNESS' be coded in the same language?

(A) 52
(B) 51
(C) 63
(D) 48

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

In a Parliamentary system, who among the following is known as the head of the Government?

(A) Prime Minister
(B) Chief Justice
(C) President
(D) Chief Minister

Q.2

In the year 1946, a three-tiered confederation for transfer of power to India was proposed by the _____.

(A) Regulating Act
(B) Rowlatt Act
(C) Cabinet Mission
(D) Simon Commission

Q.4

Which of the following features of the Indian Constitution is taken from the USA's constitution?

(A) Parliamentary Privileges
(B) Removal of Supreme Court Judges
(C) Cabinet System
(D) Prerogative Writs

Q.5

Pellagra is a deficiency disease that usually occurs due to lack of which of the following nutrients?

(A) Vitamin E
(B) Niacin
(C) Iodine
(D) Riboflavin

Q.6

Which of the following statements is INCORRECT related to Macaulay?

(A) He strongly advocated giving English language education to Indians.
(B) He considered Indian and Arab literature inferior to the Western literature.
(C) He believed that India is an uncivilised country which needs to be taught the lessons of civilisation.
(D) Macaulay was an orientalist scholar.

Q.7

When was the National Digital Communications Policy launched in India?

(A) 2018
(B) 2020
(C) 2016
(D) 2015

Q.8

Pakhu Itu dance is performed by the Apatani tribe of which of the following states?

(A) Arunachal Pradesh
(B) Chhattisgarh
(C) Himachal Pradesh
(D) Assam

Q.9

Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma is credited with single-handedly popularising which musical instrument?

(A) Santoor
(B) Sarod
(C) Sitar
(D) Tabla

Q.10

The layer made up of unconsolidated rock, dust, soil, etc. that is deposited on a bed rock surface like a blanket is known as:

(A) Protolith
(B) Regolith
(C) Talus
(D) Scree

Q.11

According to Census 2011 of India, what was the percentage of Christian communities of the total population in India?

(A) 1.7%
(B) 0.7%
(C) 0.4%
(D) 2.3%

Q.12

What monumental site in India houses Magan Niwas, Hriday Kunj and Vinoba-Mira Kutir?

(A) Sabarmati Ashram
(B) Auroville
(C) Ramchandra Mission
(D) Vinoba Ashram

Q.13

Which of the following places in India receive the highest rainfall?

(A) Imphal
(B) Guwahati
(C) Patna
(D) Mawsynram

Q.14
Who among the following rulers introduced the 'jharokha darshan' in the Mughal dynasty?

(A) Shahjahan
(B) Akbar
(C) Humayun
(D) Aurangzeb

Q.15
The duration of bouts in each round of the International Boxing Association (AIBA Open Boxing) match for Elite and Youth Men's and Women's Competitions should be _____.

(A) 5 minutes
(B) 4 minutes
(C) 2 minutes
(D) 3 minutes

Q.16
India played its first test match cricket against which of the following countries?

(A) West Indies
(B) England
(C) New Zealand
(D) Australia

Q.17
In which of the following states is the Alpasi Festival celebrated annually, where a holy bath of the deities in the sea is the primary attraction?

(A) Kerala
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Karnataka
(D) Telangana

Q.18
Who is a famous Kuchipudi Dancer to receive Padma Shri in 2001?

(A) Rekha Raju
(B) Mukti Mohan
(C) Sobha Naidu
(D) Padmini

Q.19
In December 2022, the Parliament passed the Energy Conservation (Amendment) Bill, 2022. This bill aims to make use of _____.

(A) subsidy on petrol vehicles
(B) electric vehicles
(C) tungsten filament bulbs in houses
(D) non-fossil fuels

Q.20
In which year did the Government of India pass the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act?

(A) 1999
(B) 2005
(C) 2003
(D) 2001

Q.21
Find the odd one out. Vacuoles, Nucleus, Ribosomes, Lysosomes

(A) Lysosomes
(B) Ribosomes
(C) Vacuoles
(D) Nucleus

Q.22
What is the main objective of zero-based budgeting?

(A) Examining the objectives for which funds are provided
(B) Re-evaluation of all the activities every year when budget provisions are made
(C) Establishing a relationship between inputs and outputs
(D) To assess the effectiveness of each programme and activity with the output

Q.23
What is the maximum amount of home loan the eligible beneficiaries can get under the 'Mo Ghara' scheme launched by the Government of Odisha in May 2023?

(A) Upto ₹2 lakh
(B) Upto ₹5.5 lakh
(C) Upto ₹4 lakh
(D) Upto ₹3 lakh

Q.24
The famous autobiography 'Lessons life taught me unknowingly' is related to:

(A) Sharad Pawar
(B) Anupam Kher
(C) LK Advani
(D) Jhulan Goswami

Q.25
Which property of an element is inversely related to its ionisation energy?

(A) Atomic mass
(B) Electronegativity
(C) Atomic radius
(D) Electron affinity

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. His skills in programming / are more superior than / most developers / in the company.

(A) in the company
(B) are more superior than
(C) His skills in programming
(D) most developers

Q.2
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. Suman will be fired "if she did not complete the delegated target" set by her boss.

(A) if she had not complete the delegated target
(B) if she does not complete the delegated target
(C) No substitution
(D) if she do not complete the delegated target

Q.3
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. Mithya's remarkable "generosity" extended to everyone she knew.

(A) Awkwardness
(B) Cowardice
(C) Perfection
(D) Selfishness

Q.4
Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. I cannot call him directly as I "have lost his support".

(A) am out of favour with him
(B) am quite at sea with him
(C) am in my own light
(D) am in character

Q.5
The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. (1) Malini's family (2) doesn't know (3) how she bears out (4) the work pressure.

(A) how she bears out
(B) doesn't know
(C) Malini's family
(D) the work pressure.

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Vacant

(A) Brutal
(B) Full
(C) Empty
(D) Popular

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option with the correct usage of the preposition to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) “was born during 16 November 1945”.

(A) was born in 16 November 1945
(B) was born on 16 November 1945
(C) was born by 16 November 1945
(D) was born at 16 November 1945

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Sycophant

(A) Independent
(B) Fawner
(C) Uppity
(D) Arrogant

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word 'Flash' from the given sentence. My cousin Zara, who loves to explore outer space in her free time, once noticed or observed a disc-shaped object blinking in the sky.

(A) noticed
(B) observed
(C) blinking
(D) explore

Q.10

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical/spelling error. Jack along with / his family visited / his aunt living / at America.

(A) his aunt living
(B) Jack along with
(C) at America
(D) his family visited

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. ____ architect designed ____ modern office building and ____ traditional residential home, showcasing ____ blend of contemporary and classic architectural styles.

(A) An; a; a; a
(B) A; a; an; a
(C) An; a; a; an
(D) An; a; an; a

Q.12

Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the following sentence and select its correct spelling from the given options. The teacher assessed the student’s flyer for writing.

(A) fire
(B) flare
(C) flair
(D) friar

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A short stay at a place.

(A) Embargo
(B) Sojourn
(C) Xenophobe
(D) Topiary

Q.14

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence. The restaurent's atmosphere was pleasant and inviting.

(A) restaurent's
(B) inviting
(C) pleasant
(D) atmosphere

Q.15

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. A famous economist / says that / the government should do more / for create enough jobs.

(A) the government should do more
(B) says that
(C) for create enough jobs
(D) A famous economist

Q.16

Select the correct spelling from the given options to fill in the blank. I hope you will excuse me for doing what is only my duty, although it may appear _____.

(A) impertiant
(B) impertaint
(C) impertinant
(D) impertinent

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Fast

(A) Barely
(B) Tardy
(C) Quick
(D) Languid

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The Indian Government has launched the National Rural Livelihoods Mission, a _____ programme aimed at reducing rural poverty.

(A) designer
(B) controversial
(C) regressive
(D) flagship

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Burn the midnight oil

(A) To sleep early
(B) To waste time
(C) To set things on fire
(D) To work late into the night

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One day we saw Kala Nag. The monsoons had burst with all their fury, and it had rained in the night. The earth, which had lain parched and dry under the withering heat of the summer sun, was teeming ____1___ life. In little pools, frogs croaked. The muddy ground was littered with ____2___ worms, centipedes and velvety lady-birds. Grass ____3____ begun to show and the banana leaves glistened bright and glossy green. The _____4___ had flooded Kala Nag's hole. He sat in an open patch on the lawn. His shiny black hood glistened in the sunlight. He was big, almost six feet in _____5____ and rounded and fleshy, as my wrist. "Looks like a King Cobra. Let's get him."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) in
(B) with
(C) before
(D) at

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One day we saw Kala Nag. The monsoons had burst with all their fury, and it had rained in the night. The earth, which had lain parched and dry under the withering heat of the summer sun, was teeming ____1___ life. In little pools, frogs croaked. The muddy ground was littered with ____2___ worms, centipedes and velvety lady-birds. Grass ____3____ begun to show and the banana leaves glistened bright and glossy green. The _____4___ had flooded Kala Nag's hole. He sat in an open patch on the lawn. His shiny black hood glistened in the sunlight. He was big, almost six feet in _____5____ and rounded and fleshy, as my wrist. "Looks like a King Cobra. Let's get him."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) singing
(B) crawling
(C) talking
(D) reading

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One day we saw Kala Nag. The monsoons had burst with all their fury, and it had rained in the night. The earth, which had lain parched and dry under the withering heat of the summer sun, was teeming ____1___ life. In little pools, frogs croaked. The muddy ground was littered with ____2___ worms, centipedes and velvety lady-birds. Grass ____3____ begun to show and the banana leaves glistened bright and glossy green. The _____4___ had flooded Kala Nag's hole. He sat in an open patch on the lawn. His shiny black hood glistened in the sunlight. He was big, almost six feet in _____5____ and rounded and fleshy, as my wrist. "Looks like a King Cobra. Let's get him."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) is
(B) will
(C) was
(D) had

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One day we saw Kala Nag. The monsoons had burst with all their fury, and it had rained in the night. The earth, which had lain parched and dry under the withering heat of the summer sun, was teeming ____1___ life. In little pools, frogs croaked. The muddy ground was littered with ____2___ worms, centipedes and velvety lady-birds. Grass ____3____ begun to show and the banana leaves glistened bright and glossy green. The _____4___ had flooded Kala Nag's hole. He sat in an open patch on the lawn. His shiny black hood glistened in the sunlight. He was big, almost six feet in _____5____ and rounded and fleshy, as my wrist. "Looks like a King Cobra. Let's get him."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) snow
(B) heat
(C) rain
(D) clouds

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One day we saw Kala Nag. The monsoons had burst with all their fury, and it had rained in the night. The earth, which had lain parched and dry under the withering heat of the summer sun, was teeming ____1___ life. In little pools, frogs croaked. The muddy ground was littered with ____2___ worms, centipedes and velvety lady-birds. Grass ____3____ begun to show and the banana leaves glistened bright and glossy green. The _____4___ had flooded Kala Nag's hole. He sat in an open patch on the lawn. His shiny black hood glistened in the sunlight. He was big, almost six feet in _____5____ and rounded and fleshy, as my wrist. "Looks like a King Cobra. Let's get him."

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) looks

(B) weight

(C) length

(D) circles

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (B) 100 kg

By alligation, sugar : tea = (440 − 130) : (130 − 68) = 310 : 62 = 5 : 1, so 5 × 20 = 100 kg of sugar.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 108

Cost per kg of the blend = (2 × 120 + 3 × 80)/5 = ₹96. Marked price = 1.5 × 96 = ₹144, and after 25% off: 0.75 × 144 = ₹108.

Q.3 · Answer (D) 500

P = SI × 100/(R × T) = 240 × 100/(16 × 3) = ₹500.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 540

SI = 3000 × 9 × 2/100 = ₹540.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 50.2

(40 + 49 + 56 + 69 + 37)/5 = 251/5 = 50.2 kg.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 4,725

SP = 4,500 × 1.05 = ₹4,725.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 39

The five scored 5 × 27 = 135 in all and the other four 4 × 24 = 96, so Akash scored 135 − 96 = 39.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 8

Five years ago the three totalled 3 × 27 = 81 years, so 81 + 15 = 96 now. The parents totalled 2 × 41 = 82 three years ago, so 88 now. The child is 96 − 88 = 8: born 8 years ago.

Q.15 · Answer (C) ₹5,280

SI = 36,000 × 22/100 × 8/12 = ₹5,280.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 96

The 10 weigh 10 × 64 = 640 kg and the 8 weigh 8 × 56 = 448 kg, so the grandparents weigh 192 kg together: 96 kg on average.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 60

The numbers are 3k and 7k, whose LCM is 21k = 126, so k = 6. The numbers are 18 and 42, and their sum is 60.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (B) 6

R is the only letter in both words and 6 the only digit in both codes, so R = 6.

Q.2 · Answer (B) JPMS

Each letter moves 6 places forward: K → Q, Q → W, N → T, T → Z and I → O, O → U, L → R, R → X. So D → J, J → P, G → M, M → S: JPMS.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Third to the left

Facing the centre, a person's right runs anticlockwise. G is second to B's right; E must sit between them (on G's other side, C would land on B's seat), then C is third to E's left, A second to C's left, and D, not beside B, sits between A and C. Going right from B: B, E, G, A, D, C, F, so F is third to G's left.

Q.5 · Answer (C) –501

After interchanging the signs: 60 − 9 × 63 + 72 ÷ 12 = 60 − 567 + 6 = –501.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Only conclusion II follows.

All strawberries are fruits, so some fruits are strawberries (II). The berries that are strawberries are fruits, so III is false; I need not be true, as the other berries may not be fruits.

Q.8 · Answer (C) RD 17
Each letter moves 4 places back (D wraps round to Z) and the number falls by 6: EO 19 → AK 13 and UD 17 → QZ 11. So VH 23 → RD 17.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 16
Each term is the one before divided by 2, 4, 6, 8, 10 in turn, less 6: 8796 ÷ 2 – 6 = 4392, 4392 ÷ 4 – 6 = 1092, 1092 ÷ 6 – 6 = 176, 176 ÷ 8 – 6 = 16 and 16 ÷ 10 – 6 = –4.4.

Q.10 · Answer (B) (23, 4, 96)
In each set, 4 × first + second = third: 4 × 6 + 17 = 41 and 4 × 3 + 20 = 32. Likewise 4 × 23 + 4 = 96.

Q.11 · Answer (C) NOH
First letters move back 3 (Z, W, T, Q, so N), second letters back 2 (W, U, S, Q, so O) and third letters back 3 (T, Q, N, K, so H): NOH.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Only conclusion (II) follows
'Some yaks are wipes' converts to 'some wipes are yaks' (II), which flatly contradicts I. The first statement says nothing about wipes.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Third to the right
Facing the centre, a person's right runs anticlockwise. U is second to S's right and Q third to U's left; R fifth to P's right and T third to V's left then fit only one way. Going right from S: S, T, U, R, V, P, Q. From V to the right come P, Q and then S: third to the right.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 6
M is the only letter in both words and 6 the only digit in both codes, so M = 6.

Q.17 · Answer (D) – and +
Interchanging – and +: 8 + 42 – 104 ÷ 13 × 4 = 8 + 42 – 32 = 18.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 131
Each number is five times the one it is related to: 425 ÷ 5 = 85 and 265 ÷ 5 = 53. Likewise 655 ÷ 5 = 131.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 63
The code is the square of the number of letters, less 1: PINK has 4 ($4^2 – 1 = 15$) and PAINT 5 ($5^2 – 1 = 24$). WILDNESS has 8: $8^2 – 1 = 63$.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Prime Minister
In a parliamentary system the Prime Minister heads the government; the President (or monarch) is the head of state.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Cabinet Mission
The Cabinet Mission Plan of 1946 proposed a three-tier structure: a Union at the top, groups of provinces, and the provinces.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Removal of Supreme Court Judges
The removal of Supreme Court and High Court judges, like judicial review and the Fundamental Rights, comes from the US Constitution. Parliamentary privileges, the cabinet system and prerogative writs come from Britain.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Niacin
Pellagra is caused by a lack of niacin (vitamin B3); it shows as dermatitis, diarrhoea and dementia.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Macaulay was an orientalist scholar.
Macaulay was an Anglicist, not an Orientalist: his Minute on Indian Education (1835) dismissed Indian and Arabic learning and argued for teaching Indians in English.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 2018
The National Digital Communications Policy, approved by the Union Cabinet in September 2018, replaced the National Telecom Policy of 2012.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Arunachal Pradesh
Pakhu Itu is a traditional dance of the Apatani people of the Ziro valley, Arunachal Pradesh.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Santoor
Pandit Shivkumar Sharma made the santoor, a Kashmiri folk instrument, a concert instrument of Hindustani classical music.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Regolith
Regolith is the blanket of loose, unconsolidated material (broken rock, dust and soil) that covers solid bedrock.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 2.3%
Census 2011 counted about 2.78 crore Christians, 2.3% of India's population.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Sabarmati Ashram
Hriday Kunj (Gandhi's own cottage), Magan Niwas and Vinoba-Mira Kutir all stand in the Sabarmati Ashram, Ahmedabad.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Mawsynram
Mawsynram in Meghalaya, on the southern slopes of the Khasi Hills, receives the highest average rainfall in India.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Akbar
Akbar began jharokha darshan, appearing to his subjects at a palace balcony every morning; Aurangzeb discontinued it.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 3 minutes
Under AIBA's competition rules, Elite and Youth bouts for men and women are three rounds of three minutes each, with one minute's rest between rounds.

Q.16 · Answer (B) England
India played its first Test match against England at Lord's in June 1932.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Kerala
The Alpashi festival of the Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple, Thiruvananthapuram, ends with the Aarattu, when the deities are taken in procession for a holy bath in the sea at Shanghumukham beach.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Sobha Naidu
Sobha Naidu, a Kuchipudi dancer and disciple of Vempati Chinna Satyam, received the Padma Shri in 2001.

Q.19 · Answer (D) non-fossil fuels
The Energy Conservation (Amendment) Act, 2022 lets the government require designated consumers to meet part of their energy needs from non-fossil sources, and provides for a carbon credit trading scheme.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 2005
The National Rural Employment Guarantee Act was passed in 2005; it was renamed after Mahatma Gandhi in 2009.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Ribosomes
Ribosomes have no membrane; vacuoles, the nucleus and lysosomes are membrane-bound.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Re-evaluation of all the activities every year when budget provisions are made
Zero-based budgeting starts each year's budget from zero, so every activity must be re-evaluated and justified afresh rather than carried over.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Upto ₹3 lakh
Odisha's Mo Ghara rural housing scheme, approved in May 2023, offers eligible households home loans in slabs of ₹1 lakh, ₹1.5 lakh, ₹2 lakh and ₹3 lakh, repayable over 10 years.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Anupam Kher
'Lessons Life Taught Me Unknowingly' is the autobiography of the actor Anupam Kher.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Atomic radius
The larger an atom's radius, the farther its outer electrons are from the nucleus and the more loosely they are held, so the less energy it takes to remove one.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) are more superior than
'Superior' is already comparative and takes 'to': 'are superior to', not 'are more superior than'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) if she does not complete the delegated target
A first conditional pairs 'will' in the main clause with the simple present in the 'if' clause: 'will be fired if she does not complete'.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Selfishness
'Generosity' is readiness to give to others; its opposite is 'selfishness'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) am out of favour with him
To be 'out of favour with' someone is to have lost their approval or support.

Q.5 · Answer (A) how she bears out
'Bear out' means to confirm a claim; coping with something is 'bearing' it or 'bearing up' under it: 'how she bears the work pressure'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Empty
'Vacant' means unoccupied: 'empty'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) was born on 16 November 1945
Dates take 'on': 'was born on 16 November 1945'.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Fawner
A sycophant flatters the powerful to win favour: a 'fawner'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) blinking
To 'flash' is to shine on and off briefly, as a light does when 'blinking'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) at America
Countries take 'in', not 'at': 'living in America'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) An; a; a; a
'An' goes before the vowel sound of 'architect'; 'modern', 'traditional' and 'blend' begin with consonant sounds, so they take 'a'.

Q.12 · Answer (C) flair
A natural talent is a 'flair'; a 'flyer' is a leaflet, or something that flies.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Sojourn
A sojourn is a temporary stay. An embargo is a trade ban, a xenophobe fears foreigners and topiary is the art of clipping shrubs into shapes.

Q.14 · Answer (A) restaurent's
The correct spelling is 'restaurant's'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) for create enough jobs
Purpose is expressed with the to-infinitive: 'to create enough jobs', not 'for create'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) impertinent
The correct spelling is 'impertinent' (rude, lacking proper respect).

Q.17 · Answer (C) Quick
'Fast' means 'quick'; 'tardy' and 'languid' mean slow.

Q.18 · Answer (D) flagship
A 'flagship' programme is a government's leading or most important one in its field.

Q.19 · Answer (D) To work late into the night
To 'burn the midnight oil' is to work or study late into the night.

Q.21 · Answer (B) with
'Teem with' means to be full of: the earth 'was teeming with life'.

Q.22 · Answer (B) crawling
After the rain the ground was littered with 'crawling' worms, centipedes and lady-birds.

Q.23 · Answer (D) had
'Begun' is a past participle, so it needs 'had': 'Grass had begun to show', the past perfect, as in 'had burst' and 'had rained'. 'Was begun' would be passive, which makes no sense for grass.

Q.24 · Answer (C) rain
'The rain had flooded Kala Nag's hole': the passage opens with the monsoon rain of the night before.

Q.25 · Answer (C) length
Six feet is a measure of how long the snake was: 'six feet in length'.

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